

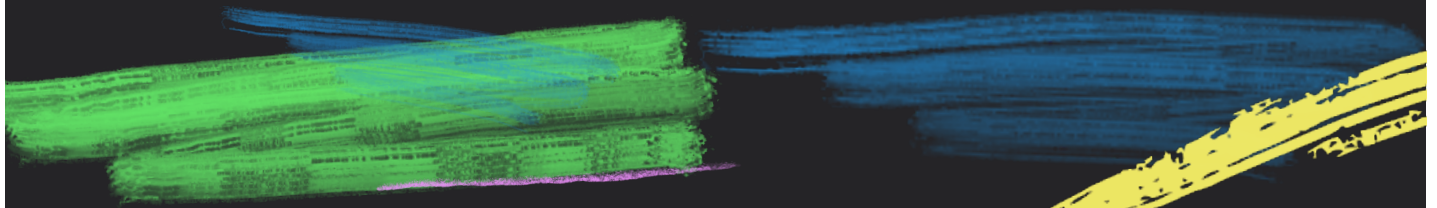


REACH, A BRAND OF REFRESH · PREPARED FOR SOMERSET ACADEMY

Families engaged. Teachers who stay.

How REACH can carry the family engagement Somerset is known for, and help keep great teachers year after year, across every campus in the network.

Brief · about a 5-minute read · September 2026



What is in here. A short note, what Somerset has said matters, where REACH could fit, the features that matter most for the network, and a way to start. There is also a [PDF of this document](#).

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SECTION 1

A note

Hello,

Somerset has always stood out for its family engagement and close school communities, and keeping great teachers year after year is the other half of that. Those are the two things our REACH platform is built for.

I lead the public-serving division of Refresh. REACH is a mobile app branded as Somerset that reaches families and staff on their phones. For families, it puts school communication, forms, and community resources like food, housing, and health coverage in one place. For teachers and staff, it brings onboarding, benefits, wellness, and recognition together across every campus, so a new hire in August feels part of Somerset on day one.

Communication runs both ways, so families and staff don't just hear from Somerset, Somerset hears from them.

We usually start with one or two campuses and one or two modules, then grow as people use it. Would you be open to a 20-minute conversation about how it could work across the network?

Adrian Gessen

Refresh · Public-Serving Division · REACH

SECTION 2

What Somerset has said matters

FROM THE START	Somerset Academy was founded in 1997 to be a technologically immersive, student-empowering, and family-engaging alternative, and the network describes family engagement and collaborative leadership as part of how it works.
TEACHERS WHO STAY	Campus plans set goals to recruit, develop, and retain highly qualified teachers and staff, and to raise the share of teachers with more than five years of experience.
RESOURCES, COORDINATED	Campus plans commit to coordinating federal, state, and local resources for equitable outcomes, with targeted growth for students in special education and students learning English.

A note on sources. Somerset does not publish a network-wide strategic plan. These points come from the network's own history and from published campus improvement plans, listed in Section 6.

SECTION 3

Where REACH could fit

Families	Teachers and staff	Across the network
COMMUNICATIONS · FORMS · COMMUNITY RESOURCES Updates, reminders, and forms on the phone, in the family's language, with support like food, housing, and health coverage that finds them. Families answer back, too.	BENEFITS ACCESS · HEALTH AND WELLNESS · REWARDS, RECOGNITION, AND PERKS Ready before day one, benefits that surface when life changes, wellbeing on the phone, and recognition that the whole campus sees.	THE PLATFORM One Somerset-branded home on every campus, connected to the systems already in use, with participation visible by campus and role.

The features that matter most here

A subset of the full feature list, chosen for family engagement and teacher retention. The complete list is in [REACH Modules and Features](#).

Serves Team Community Both

FEATURE	TYPICAL TODAY	WITH REACH	SERVES
THE PLATFORM IN EVERY MODULE			
White-labeled front door Your name, your look	Vendor-branded apps, one per tool	One branded home for everything your people use For you: A Somerset-branded app, with each campus visible inside it.	Both
iOS, Android, mobile web, and web Every device	A desktop portal, or a different app for every vendor	Native iOS and Android apps plus mobile web and web, all carrying your name	Both
One layer over your systems Thousands of integrations	A portal of tiles, a separate login behind each	Connects HR, payroll, benefits, and the tools you already run into one experience, with no extra logins	Both
Segmentation and role-based access Right content, right person	One message and one menu for everyone	Each person sees what fits their role, location, and program For you: Segment by campus, grade, and role.	Both
Automated language translation In the language people use	English only, or translation by hand	Content is translated automatically into the language each person uses For you: Families of students learning English receive updates in their own language.	Both
Two-way by design Connects in both directions	Messages go out; little comes back	Organizations reach people, people reach help and each other, and feedback flows back to the organization For you: Keeps the family engagement Somerset is known for running in both directions.	Both
Data analytics and reporting Beyond activity counts	Reports pulled by hand, after the fact	Real-time participation by team, location, or role, with nudges for the people going quiet	Both
01 COMMUNICATIONS Start here			
Reach without email Channel matters	Email and flyers that deskless staff and families miss	Push, text, email, and in-app news feed, routed to the channel each person actually answers	Both
Chat Conversations in one place	Personal texts and group chats outside any system	Built-in chat, or a connection to the chat service already in use	Both

FEATURE	TYPICAL TODAY	WITH REACH	SERVES
Scheduling and calendar Segmented scheduling	Paper calendars and phone trees	Full scheduling that works with any calendar: sign-ups, reminders, and check-ins for shifts, trainings, appointments, and classes	Both
02 BENEFITS ACCESS Start here			
Benefits at the right moment Life events	A guide handed out once a year at open enrollment	Personalized, step-by-step journeys surface the right benefit at a life event: a new baby, a move, open enrollment	Team
AI benefits assistant Answers in plain language	Calling HR or the insurer to ask what is covered	A built-in AI assistant explains benefits and coverage in plain language, any time	Team
Benefits enrollment One flow	A separate enrollment site for every product	One enrollment flow across products and third-party systems	Team
Public benefits navigation Medicaid, SNAP, WIC	A referral list, one program at a time	Guides people to Medicaid, SNAP, WIC, and sliding-scale care. The agency and program still decide eligibility. For you: Helps coordinate the federal, state, and local resources the campus plans commit to.	Community
03 COMMUNITY RESOURCES Start here			
Local help, searchable Free and reduced-cost services	A printed list that goes stale	Free and reduced-cost local services for food, housing, transportation, health, and work, searchable by where a person lives	Community
Resources that find you Location and situation	Search it yourself, if you know to look	Surfaced on its own, by where a person is and what they are working on now	Community
04 HEALTH AND WELLNESS Start here			
Wellness on demand A 100+ hour content library	An assistance line on a breakroom poster	Fitness classes, yoga, HIIT, sleep stories, mindfulness, nutrition, and health management, plus your own content	Both
05 REWARDS, RECOGNITION, AND PERKS Start here			
Kudos and milestones Peer to peer or manager to team	Recognition that stays in an inbox	Peer and manager kudos, anniversaries, and milestones on the social feed, automated by tenure or role For you: Recognition is one of the least expensive ways to help teachers stay.	Both
Rewards catalog Monetary and non-monetary	Paper certificates, if anything	A customizable catalog of gift cards and non-monetary awards	Both
Perks and discounts Everyday savings	A perks list nobody uses	Giveaways and discounts on services, travel, and live events from leading brands For you: Everyday savings add value to a teacher's total rewards without adding salary cost.	Both
06 CHALLENGES AND POINTS			
Challenges on demand 300+ ready to launch	A campaign once a year	Any action can become a challenge, and several can run at once, from a library of more than 300	Both
07 FORMS AND SURVEYS			

FEATURE	TYPICAL TODAY	WITH REACH	SERVES
Digital forms Delivered in sequence	Paper intake and consent forms	Upload existing forms or build new ones, deliver them to the right groups automatically, and track each response	Both
Surveys and polls Feedback that comes back	One annual survey with low response	Snap polls and pulse surveys, fully automated, with visibility into who opened and who responded	Both
USE CASE: ONBOARDING BUILT FROM THE MODULES ABOVE			
Ready before day one Personalized	Binders and a first-week scramble	Benefits, forms, and team connections personalized to role, location, and life stage For you: Summer hiring across many campuses, with one consistent start for every new teacher.	Team
Welcome messaging Automated, personal	Ad hoc emails, if any	A manager welcome, team introductions, and benefits reminders at the right time	Team

"Typical today" describes the common shape of standalone tools and portals, not any named product. Features reflect Refresh platform capabilities published at refreshplatform.com and in REACH program materials as of September 2026. REACH is a software platform; it does not make eligibility decisions for any public benefit or program.

SECTION 5

A way to start

1
Pick the campuses
One or two campuses, ideally with different grade bands.

2
Pick the modules
Usually Communications for families and Onboarding or Recognition for staff.

3
Launch
Our customer success team handles setup, configuration, and onboarding.

4
Grow with adoption
Add campuses and modules as families and staff use it.

SECTION 6

Links

[Somerset Academy Inc. History](#)

The founding vision: technologically immersive, student-empowering, and family-engaging.

Somerset Academy Oaks, Campus Improvement Plan 2024-2025

Teacher and staff recruitment, development, and retention goals.

Somerset Academy Brooks, Campus Plan 2025-2026

Coordinating federal, state, and local resources for equitable outcomes.

REACH Modules and Features

The full set of nine modules and every feature, for anyone who wants the whole picture.

Refresh

The platform behind REACH.



REACH, a brand of Refresh Software, Inc. · Public-Serving Division · info@refreshplatform.com · refreshplatform.com